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Dubai property sales near Dh500b

DUBAI
BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Dubai's real estate market set a new high in the third quarter of 2025, pushing total sales for the first nine months close to half a trillion dirhams.

As per market data, 59,228 sales transactions worth Dh170.7 billion were recorded in Q3, representing a 17.2 per cent increase in volume and a 19.9 per cent increase in value compared to the same period last year. Figures from DXBinteract indicate that total transactions from January to September reached 158,200, with a value of Dh498.8 billion, representing a 20.5 per cent increase in volume and a 32.3 per cent rise in value compared to the same period in 2024.

Apartments led the activity, with 49,370 units sold for Dh94.3 billion, up 25.9 per cent year-on-year. Commercial deals increased by 41.9 per cent to 1,565 transactions, valued at Dh4.2 billion. Plot sales reached 1,214, up 25.7 per cent, worth Dh36.1 billion. According to Provident Estate, studios and 1-bedroom apartments were especially popular, catering to entry-level investors and young professionals, while villas and town houses appealed to families seeking modern communities.

Villas recorded 7,078 sales totalling Dh43.1 billion, a 23.3 per cent drop in volume but supported by higher prices, with price per square foot up 11.4 per cent.

Gaza flotilla interception sparks global condemnation, protests

STRIKES AND STREET RALLIES ERUPT ACROSS EUROPE AND LATIN AMERICA

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N.R.
Senior Associate Editor

Governments, rights groups and activists around the world condemned Israel yesterday after its naval forces intercepted the Global Sumud Flotilla en route to Gaza, detaining dozens of passengers, including Swedish climate campaigner Greta Thunberg.

Protests erupted in cities from Rome to Buenos Aires, as calls grew for the activists' release.

The convoy of about 45 vessels, carrying symbolic amounts of humanitarian aid, had set sail from Spain in early September. By Thursday morning, communications with most ships had been lost. Greek officials confirmed that 39 had been intercepted and diverted to the Israeli port of Ashdod.

Israel's foreign ministry described the flotilla as a " Hamas-Sumud provocation," insisting that none of the boats breached what it called a lawful blockade. It said all passengers were in good health and would be deported to Europe.

Unlawful detention

Organisers rejected that claim, accusing Israel of unlawful detention after live-streams and contact with several vessels were cut. Eleven Greek nationals detained in the operation have gone on hunger strike, according to Greece's foreign minister.

Amnesty International denounced the seizure as "an act of intimidation" aimed at silencing critics of Israel's Gaza blockade, while Hamas called it "pi-



AP

■ This combination of images released by the Israeli Foreign Ministry shows Greta Thunberg (second from right) with other flotilla activists after the Israeli navy intercepted the Global Sumud Flotilla carrying humanitarian aid to Gaza, yesterday.

TRUMP WARNS HAMAS OVER GAZA PLAN 'RED LINE'

White House Press Secretary Karoline Leavitt said on Wednesday that President Donald Trump expects Hamas to accept his Gaza proposal and is prepared to impose consequences if it does not.

"It's a red line that the president of the United States is going to have to draw, and I'm confident that he will," Leavitt told Fox News.

On Tuesday, Trump said he was giving Hamas "three or four days" to respond to the plan. The US has repeatedly advanced proposals backed by Israel but resisted by Palestinians, blaming Hamas for blocking ceasefire efforts.

racy and maritime terrorism." Spain summoned Israel's envoy and announced a prosecutor-led probe into possible crimes against humanity. Colombia said it would expel Israeli diplomats, Turkey denounced the inter-

ceptions as terrorism and South Africa demanded the release of all detainees, including Mandela Mandela, grandson of Nelson Mandela.

Italy, which earlier provided naval escorts for the flotilla, dis-

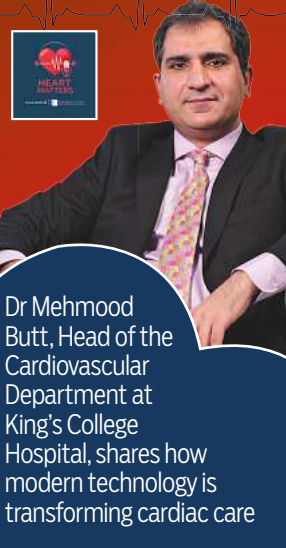
tanced itself from the mission. Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni said the voyage risked undermining US President Donald Trump's proposed Gaza peace plan and would not help Palestinians. Still, Italy's largest unions announced new strikes after protests in Rome and Naples, adding to solidarity rallies in Berlin, Athens and Latin America.

The flotilla had already reported three encounters with drones during its voyage, including two after a stop in Tunisia. Spain and Italy had both warned the activists to turn back before entering Israel's declared exclusion zone.

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NATION | P2

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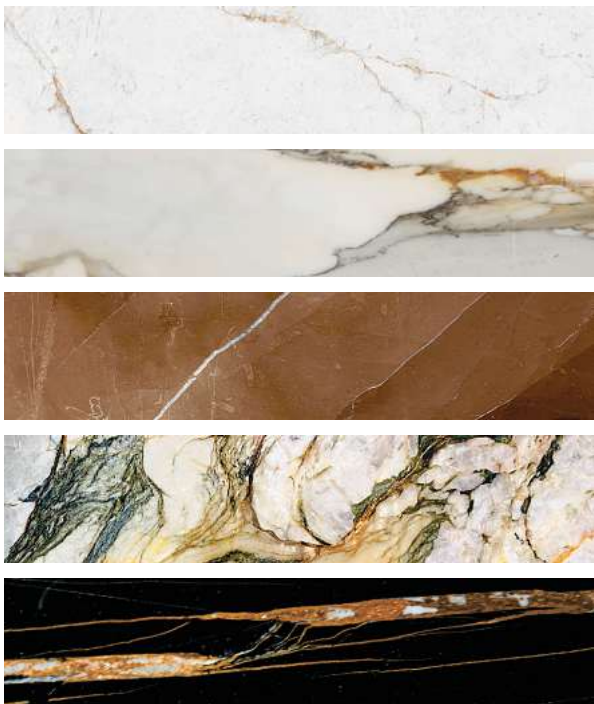


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